3 December 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-2329B
18 October 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SHEATH, MACHETE (FOR 18 INCH LONG, 2-1/4 INCH WIDE BLADE)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a plastic sheath for the M-1942 machete with 18 inch blade.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-698	-	Steel, Sheet and Strip, Low-Carbon
QQ-Z-325	-	Zinc Coating, Electrodeposited, Requirements For
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes

MILITARY

MIL-E-480	-	Enamel, Baking, Phenol- or Urea-Formaldehyde
MIL-H-639	-	Hooks (For Belts, Straps, and Equipage Items)

FSC 8465

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWING

ARMY NATICK DEVELOPMENT CENTER

8-2-222 - Sheath, Machete, Assembly and Details

(Miniature reproduction of referenced drawing is attached for information only).

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procurement activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036).

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606).

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American Society for Testing and Materials Standards

D 412	-	Tension Testing of Vulcanized Rubber
D 638	-	Tensile Properties of Plastics
D 747	-	Stiffness of Plastics by Means of a Cantilever Beam
D 1505	-	Density of Plastics by the Density-Gradient Technique
D 1525	-	Vicat Softening Point of Plastics

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Guide sample. Guide samples of the end item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.4). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish three finished sheath from each mold cavity for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.5).

3.2 Components and materials.

3.2.1 Plastic resin. The material used to make the body of the sheath shall be virgin ethylene-vinyl acetate copolymer resin having physical properties listed in table I.

TABLE I. Physical properties of plastic resin

Property	Requirement
Density, grams per c.c. (natural resin)	0.926 ± 0.003
Tensile strength, p.s.i., minimum	1750
Ultimate elongation, percent, minimum	600
Vicat softening temperature, rate A degrees centigrade, minimum	75
Stiffness in flexure, p.s.i.	10,000 to 12,000

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3.2.2 Hooks. The hooks shall conform to type I, class 1 or 2, size 1 of MIL-H-639.

3.2.3 Hook plate, clips and holder. The hook plate, clips and holder shall be made of low-carbon sheet or strip steel conforming to cold, rolled, commercial quality and any temper of QQ-S-698, except as shown on Drawing 8-2-222.

3.2.4 Rivets. The rivets for securing the hook plate and sharpener to the sheath body shall be solid, made of copper and dimensioned as shown on Drawing 8-2-222. The rivets shall have a commercial dark oxide finish.

3.2.5 Tungsten carbide inserts. The tungsten carbide for the inserts shall be C-2 carbide.

3.2.6 Copper braze. The tungsten carbide inserts shall be brazed securely to the steel clips with copper braze.

3.2.7 Finish for hardware. Prior to assembly to the machete sheath, the hardware (hookplate and sharpener assembly after brazing and welding) shall be given the same finish as required for the hook. The hardware shall be zinc plated and phosphated in accordance with type III, class 2 of QQ-Z-325, and then coated with a black bake type enamel conforming to type II of MIL-E-480. The enamel shall be uniform in appearance and color, and shall be free from sags, runs, cracks, flakes, streaks and areas of no film. After attachment of the hardware, the peened or spun ends of the hook plate rivet and both ends of the sharpener rivets shall be spot-painted with a commercial black, air drying adherent enamel or lacquer whose gloss approximates that of the hardware enamel. Areas of the hardware from which paint has been removed during assembly operations shall also be spot painted as indicated for the rivets.

3.3 Design, construction, and dimensions. The design, construction, and dimensions of the sheath shall be as shown on Drawing No. 8-2-222.

3.3.1 Plastic sheath body. The body of the sheath shall be injection molded from the resin specified in 3.2.1. A maximum of 20 percent, by weight of the blended mixture, of clean, unburned plastic material in the form of imperfect parts, sprues, runners, gates or other scraps of the same composition as the virgin material and produced in the molding or finishing operation, may be reground and mixed with the material specified in 3.2.1.

3.4 Fit of machete in sheath. The sheath shall pass the fit test in 4.5.1 using the specified standard machete.

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3.5 Color. The color of the sheath body shall approximate color number 34087 of FED-STD-595.

3.6 Finish. The exterior surface of the sheath body shall have a lusterless stipple finish produced by the molding technique and not by the application of protective coating of lacquer or related materials.

3.7 Identification marking. The sheath body shall be marked as shown on Drawing 8-2-222, by an embossed molded-in process with the letters U.S., the year of manufacture, and the supplier's name or trademark or marking of such known character as to be readily identified with the supplier. The marking area shall be approximately 1 square inch and the markings shall be raised approximately 0.007 inch in height.

3.8 Instructions for use. An instruction sheet containing the following legend shall be furnished with each sheath (see 5.1.1). The heading and item 5 of the instruction sheet shall be in capital letters 10 point minimum (approximately 1/8 inch). The remainder of the instruction sheet shall be 8 point minimum (3/32 inch). The instruction sheet shall be approximately 8 by 6 inches.

OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS FOR MACHETE SHARPENER

1. With machete in sheath, remove entire belt assembly from around waist or remove sheath from belt.

2. Rotate sharpener so that V-shaped notch projects into sheath opening.

3. Place edge of sheath with sharpener against any flat surface. Keep fingers away from sharpener.

4. Press down on top of case and make firm contact between machete and sharpener as machete is pulled from sheath. Do not re-insert blade unless sharpener has been pivoted out of the way. One or two withdrawals should be sufficient for most uses.

5. Never attempt to sharpen machete by holding sharpener in place by hand either on the belt or off. This procedure may easily result in loss of a finger.

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3.9 Workmanship. The sheath body shall be clean and free from bubbles, cracks, flash and surface blemishes. The metal hardware shall be free from rust, sharp edges (except where required), or burrs. Rivets shall be peened over sufficiently to secure components and still allow required swiveling or rotation.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2), the first article submitted in accordance with 3.1.2 shall be visually inspected as specified in 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship, dimensional and fit requirements.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all of the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition, testing shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for the characteristics shown.

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The sample unit shall be a compression molded blank or sheet 12 by 12 inches by 0.075 ± 0.005 inch or four 6 by 6 inches by 0.075 ± 0.005 inch blank or sheets. The sample size for the designated lot size shall be as follows:

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,000 and more	5

There shall be no evidence of failure of any sample unit to meet the requirement as specified. All requirements are applicable to the sample unit. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The number of determinations per sample unit shall be in accordance with the applicable test method.

TABLE II. Instructions for testing

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test method ASTM	Results reported to nearest
Plastic resin	Density	Table I	D1505	0.001 gm./cc.
	Tensile strength	Table I	D 638 1/	5 p.s.i.
	Ultimate elongation	Table I	D 638 1/	5 percent
	Vicat softening temperature	Table I	D1525	Degree C
	Stiffness in flexure	Table I	D 747 2/	5 p.s.i.

1/ Specimens shall be prepared using Die C described in Method of Tension Testing of Vulcanized Rubber, ASTM designation D412-68. The bench mark separation shall be 1.000 inch ± 0.003 inch. The speed of jaw separation shall be 20 inches per minute.

2/ Specimen size - 3-1/2 inches long, 1 inch wide, and .075 inch thick.

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4.4.2 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for defects listed in 4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2 and for defects in 4.4.2.3 applicable to preparation for delivery. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sheath for examinations in 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be as specified in 4.4.2.4.

4.4.2.1 Visual examination of the end item. The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheath.

Examine	Defect
Design	Any characteristic not in accordance with specified requirements
Construction:	
Hardware	Any hardware component broken, bent, cracked or malformed Any hardware component missing, not assembled or not located as specified Any rivet not securely peened Any rivet too tightly peened interfering with rotation or swiveling of hook plate or sharpener assembly Hook binds in hook plate, or hook cannot be rotated Hook loosely bound in hook plate causing hook to slip out of hook eye
Body of sheath	Weld along sides of body not sound, continuous, smooth, or free of flash
Finish:	
Hardware	Not black color Not uniform Tacky Flakes, peel or rubs off An indication of rust
Body of sheath	Not color specified Not lusterless, stippled finish Produced by protective coating in lieu of molding technique Overall uncleanliness

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Examine	Defect
Workmanship	Any tear, cut, hole (except as required), crack or break in sheath body Any pits, nodules, burrs, slivers or sharp edges on hardware More than 28 core pin holes on both sides of sheath More than 14 core pin holes on one side of sheath Core pin holes not distributed in a uniform pattern Any bubble, flash or surface blemish Any distorted bulging or waviness Sporadic glossiness or discoloration
Marking	Omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, not proper size or misplaced

4.4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheath. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall constitute a defect.

4.4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of Section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application
Materials	Any component missing Any component damaged, affecting serviceability
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per interior package and shipping container is more or less than required

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4.4.2.4 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels. Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

Examination	Inspection level	AQL
4.4.2.1	II	6.5
4.4.2.2	S-2	1.5
4.4.2.3	S-2	2.5

4.4.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.1 for fit of the machete in sheath. The sample unit shall be one sheath. The sample size shall be 5. There shall be no evidence of failure of any sample unit to meet the requirement specified. Results shall be reported as pass or fail.

4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Fit test. The fit test shall be performed with a standard 18 inch long by 2-1/4 inch wide blade rigid handle machete (see 6.3). The machete and sheath shall be conditioned for two hours minimum prior to testing, and tested at a temperature of 25, $\pm$ 2 degrees centergrade. The sheaths shall be broken in by insertion and removal of the machete into the sheath ten times prior to the test. The machete shall be inserted in the sheath with the handle centrally located in the sheath opening. The sheath shall then be vertically suspended from the hole in the tip (as shown on Drawing 8-2-222) by means of a hook. Attach a one pound weight to the hole in the machete handle. The machete shall not be released from the sheath within 30 seconds. Remove the one pound weight and substitute a 10 pound weight. The machete shall be released from the sheath within 30 seconds.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Ten sheaths with the sharpener in the "up" position, shall be alternately reversed end for end and stacked to form a bundle. The stacking shall be such that only the blade portion of each sheath is placed on top of another with the tip just short of the shoulder of the adjacent sheath. The bundle shall be securely tied with cotton tape or twine approximately 4 inches in from each end of the bundle. An instruction sheet shall be compactly folded and inserted into the mouth of each sheath (see 3.9).

5.1.2 Level C. Sheaths shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement. An instruction sheet shall accompany each sheath (see 3.9).

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred sheaths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each PPP-B-636 shipping container shall be fitted with a tape liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-F-320. Level A packages shall be packed flat (flat surface of sheath) one in length, five in width and two in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 24 inches in length, 17-1/4 inches in width and 15 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred sheaths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat (flat surface of sheath) one in length, five in width and two in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 24 inches in length, 17-1/4 inches in width and 15 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fabricated and closed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Sheaths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Each interior package shall have attached a manila colored paper shipping tag for this identification information.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The sheath is intended to be used as a protective cover and carrying case for the model M-1942 machete.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1.2, 4.3 and 6.4).
(c) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 For access to samples, and rigid handle machetes required for fit examination (see 4.5.1) address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of one finished sheath from each mold cavity. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - MC
Air Force - 82

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8465-0330

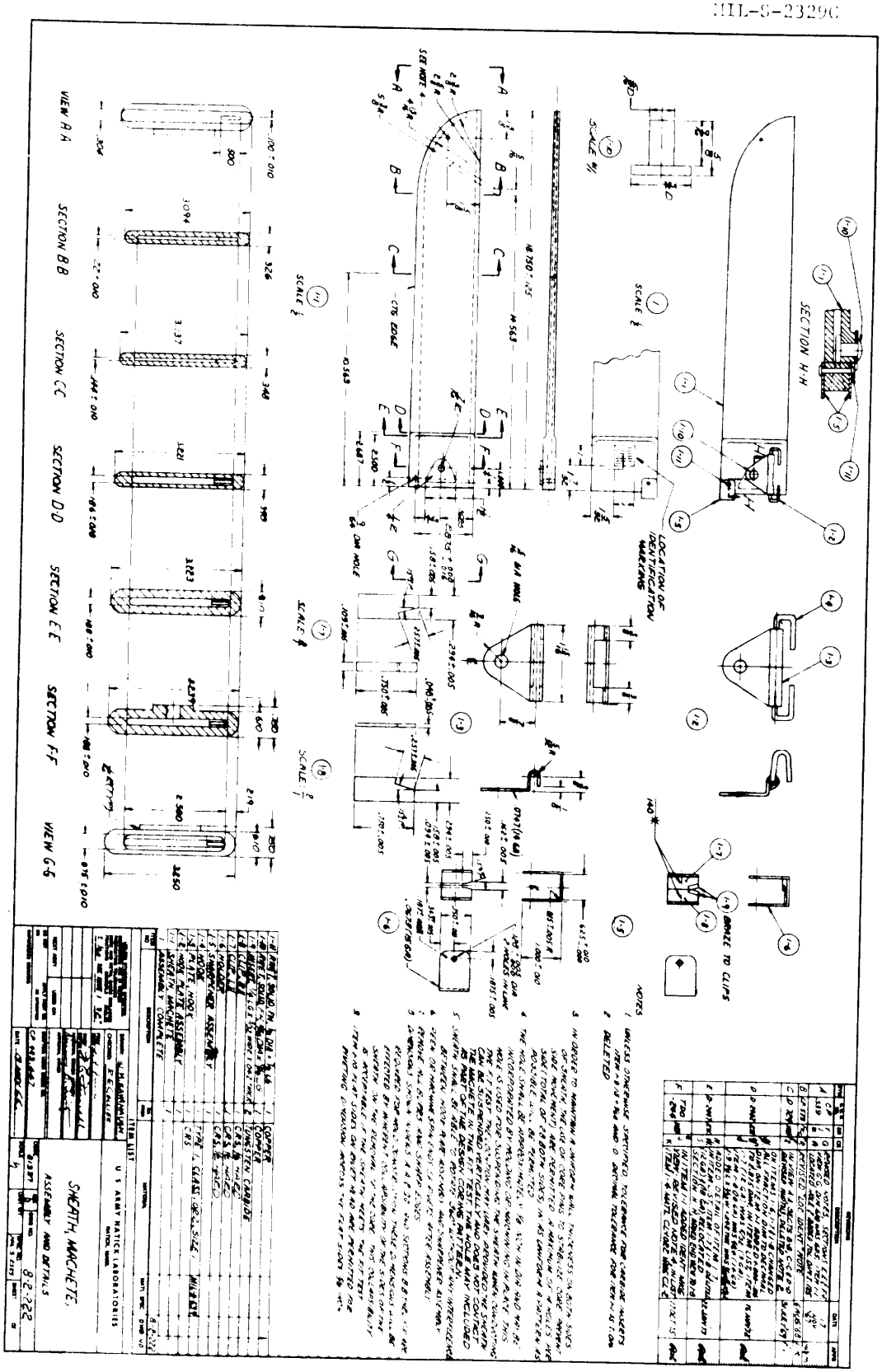
Review activities:

Air Force - 69
Army - ME

User activities:

Navy - MC

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-S-2329C - SHEATH, MACHETE (FOR 18 INCH LONG, 2-1/4 INCH WIDE BLADE)

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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